

# Software Modernization Strategies



## Ignore It!

Leave your system alone as long as it does its job well.



## Keep It Alive!

Keep your legacy system running, but make it a conscious choice, not a habit.



## Delegate!

Hand off what is holding you back and focus on what actually matters.



## Give It Away!

Open-source what you can no longer advance alone, and let the community share the load.



## Sell It!

Sell your legacy system to someone for whom it is worth more than it is to you.



## Buy New!

Buy a ready-made solution when someone else has already solved your problem.



## Shut It Down!

End your legacy system's operation in a planned, orderly, and drama-free way.



## Consolidate It!

Replace your zoo of systems with fewer, more manageable units.



## Standardize It!

Define how your systems are built, connected, and operated, and end the chaos.



## Harmonize It!

Align your systems, models, and processes so they work together without friction.



## Partner It!

Work with external partners to evolve your system together.



## Bring It Back!

Take back control of your system when outsourcing costs more than it delivers.



## Rethink It!

Do not question your system, question the assumptions it was built on.



## Remodel It!

Align your system's structure with the domain as you understand it today.



## Trim it down!

Remove what nobody needs anymore and give your system its actual purpose back.



## Improve It!

Keep your system fit through continuous, unspectacular work before the debt catches up with you.



## Convert it!

Keep your system's proven logic and only swap out the technology it lives in.



## Fork It!

Split off part of your system and turn it into a standalone, independent solution.



## Repurpose It!

Deploy your system for a new audience instead of maintaining it for a shrinking market.



## Salvage It!

Keep the valuable components of your legacy system and leave the rest behind.



## Wrap it!

Leave the core untouched and only modernize how your system talks to the outside world.



## Replace it!

Build new when the old system is more burden than value.



## Divide It!

Cut your system along its natural boundaries so one change no longer puts the whole system at risk.



## Extract!

Pull the knowledge out of your system before you take the next step.



## Preserve it!

Preserve your system so you can still start it when needed, without actively maintaining it.



## Replatform it!

Give your system a new foundation when the code is still good but what is underneath no longer is.



## Rehost it!

Move your system to a new environment and leave everything else as it is.



## Upgrade Tools!

Bring your tooling up to date so legacy work becomes more efficient.



## Align Strategy!

Align your organization's strategic direction toward a realistic approach to legacy.



## Reshape Org!

Reshape teams, responsibilities, and incentives so legacy work finally works well.



## Upskill People!

Invest in the people you already have before investing in new technology.



## Improve Processes!

De-rust not the system, but the way your team works with it.

Strategy Categories: Business (14) Development (10) Infrastructure (3) Enablement (5)

